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APRIL 2026

**U/103/24-25/AT00101/
24-25/35105**

Paper I – ENGLISH

Time : Three hours

Maximum : 100 marks

SECTION A — (10 × 2 = 20 marks)

Answer ALL the questions.

1. Correct the errors and rewrite the sentences.
 - (a) She don't like play football.
 - (b) They was going to school yesterday.
2. Correct the errors and rewrite the sentences.
 - (a) If I will see him tomorrow, I will tell him the news.
 - (b) The book which I bought it yesterday is very interesting.

3. Correct the errors and rewrite the sentences
 - (a) Despite of the rain, the match continued.
 - (b) She is married with a doctor.
4. Fill in the blanks with suitable pronouns.
 - (a) This phone belongs to John. It is _____ phone.
 - (b) We saw a little cat. _____ was hiding under the table.
5. Write negative ends for the following sentences.
 - (a) He is brilliant, but (mad)
 - (b) They are groups, but (united)
6. Complete the following sentences with the correct tense of the verbs given in brackets:
 - (a) Look! The children _____ (play) in the garden right now.
 - (b) If it _____ (rain) tomorrow, we will cancel the picnic.
7. Give the synonyms of:
 - (a) Hostile
 - (b) Partly.

8. Give the antonyms of:
- (a) Generous
 - (b) Permanent.
9. Use the word *inconsolable* in a meaningful sentence.
10. Use the phrase *jazzed-up* in a meaningful sentence.

SECTION B — ($5 \times 7 = 35$ marks)

Answer ALL the questions in about 150 words each.

11. Read the following passage and answer the questions given.

The city will be enforcing winter parking rules from December 1 through March 31, according to City Street Manager, Joseph Parks. This includes alternate-side parking regulations, as well as tow-away zones and handicap exceptions. Cars are to be parked on the south and east sides of streets between the hours of 8 a.m. and midnight; and on the north and west sides of streets between midnight and 8 a.m. This is to permit snow plows and emergency vehicles access to all

neighborhoods as well as to keep rush-hour traffic to a minimum. Vehicles that do not follow these guidelines will be towed at the owner's expense, Parks said, with the exception of those vehicles displaying handicapped parking permits.

- (a) What is the main idea of this passage?
 - (i) Cars should be parked on the street.
 - (ii) Snow plows can bury cars under snow.
 - (iii) Winter parking regulations will be put into effect.
 - (iv) Winter parking regulations are good for the environment.
- (b) When should cars be parked on the west side of the street?
 - (i) between 8 a.m. and midnight.
 - (ii) between midnight and 8 a.m.
 - (iii) between December 1 and March 31.
 - (iv) not stated.

- (c) Which of the following is NOT a reason for these parking regulations to be followed?
 - (i) They prevent excessive traffic.
 - (ii) It's good for the cars to be moved frequently in cold weather.
 - (iii) It allows snow plows to get through.
 - (iv) They enable emergency vehicles to gain access to all neighbourhoods.
- (d) Explain the following terms:
 - (i) alternate-side parking regulations.
 - (ii) tow-away zones.
 - (iii) handicap exceptions.
- (e) Why does the city have different parking regulations for winter?

12. Comment on the picture given below:

REFORESTATION

Compare and contrast both the pictures and write a few sentences on the similarities and the dissimilarities between the images.



13. (a) Discuss the theme of the relationship between nature and humans as seen in the poem “A Bird, came down the Walk”?

Or

- (b) Explain how Maathai highlights the importance of protecting the environment for future generations.

14. (a) How does the film use visuals and storytelling to inspire awareness about protecting endangered species in Elephant Whisperers?

Or

- (b) Explore the theme of longing or desire in “Flavours that Attracted the Cream.” How does the writer develop this feeling?
15. (a) What role does the bicycle play as a symbol in the poem “The Bicycle and the Sweet Shop”?

Or

- (b) How does “The Last Leaf” reflect the social and cultural context of early 20th century urban life, particularly in terms of community and artistic struggle? Provide examples from the text.

SECTION C — (3 × 15 = 45 marks)

Answer the following in about 250 words.

16. Read the following news report and answer the questions.

Auditor asks police to probe university entry exam leaks.

An investigation by South Korea's state auditor has uncovered allegations of collusion between high school teachers and private education companies, pointing to an illicit organisation set up specifically to leak exam questions in exchange for cash, ahead of the country's highly competitive annual university entrance examination. The watchdog report has once again put Korea's private cram school sector in the spotlight. Successive governments have called for closer scrutiny of the sector which provides exam related tutoring after school and at weekends, as well as fairness in the university entrance exam system.

Police investigation On 11 March, the Board of Audit and Inspection of Korea disclosed that it had requested a police investigation into 56 individuals, including current public high school teachers and officials suspected of violating laws

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that prohibit solicitation, obstruction of duty, and embezzlement related to the annual standardised College Scholastic Ability Test, or Suneung in Korean. Among those being investigated by police are 27 current teachers, a university professor, four employees of the Korean Institute for Curriculum and Evaluation (KICE) — the organisation that administers the Suneung — a former college admissions officer, and 23 individuals associated with the private academy sector, as cram schools are sometimes referred to. According to the auditor, several individuals received bribes exceeding US\$38,000 over five years, 2018-2023, and were involved in “significance criminal activities” regardless of the amounts that changed hands. In a press release, the auditor expressed deep concern over what it termed the existence of an “education cartel” in terms of which current teachers allegedly colluded with private academies to compromise the fairness and trustworthiness of national exams like the Suneung by selling mock university admission exam questions, reflecting Suneung trends, to the academies.

Cash-for questions ring

The audit highlighted seven cases from its three-month investigation which began last September. One case related to teachers directly managing

and operating a ring for trading exam questions. A teacher was alleged to have recruited eight colleagues during Suneung preparation sessions for the cash-for questions ring. The ringleader, a teacher who had served on Suneung review committees, purportedly supplied over 2,000 mock exam questions reflecting Suneung trends to companies running private academies, and to renowned academy instructors from 2019 to May 2023, receiving over US\$500,000 for these services. In another case, a high school teacher and his spouse operated a publishing company. They recruited 35 individuals, including teachers they met while producing materials for the public educational broadcaster EBS, to devise exam questions reflecting Suneung trends. He allegedly supplied these to private education companies and

well-known academy instructors from 2019 to 2022, generating sales worth US\$1.42 million.

Questions

- (a) What is the objective of this report?
- (b) Why, according to the report, did ‘several individuals’ receive bribes?
- (c) What did the investigation by South Korea’s state auditors reveal?

- (d) Why did the Board of Auditors request a police investigation?
- (e) Why were a high school teacher and his spouse being investigated?
- (f) What is a ‘cram school’?
- (g) The term ‘education cartel’ refers to _____.
- (h) What do you understand from the title of the passage?
- (i) The captain has denied _____ of wrongdoing.
 - (i) blame
 - (ii) allegation
 - (iii) suspect
 - (iv) investigation.
- (j) This is strictly _____ in accordance with international civil aviation law.
 - (i) permitted
 - (ii) encouraged
 - (iii) supported
 - (iv) prohibited.

17. (a) Write a recipe for an evening snack of your choice. (5)
- (b) Write a brief review of your favourite restaurant in Chennai. (10)
18. (a) Critically analyse the documentary “The Elephant Whisperers”.

Or

- (b) How does O. Henry portray the idea of sacrifice in “The Last Leaf”?
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